

Ignored files

A `.gitignore` entry tells Git to ignore matching files that are not already tracked. An ignored `secret.txt` remains in the working directory but does not become an ordinary untracked candidate for version control.

Stash eligibility

The default git stash operation saves changes to tracked files and changes already staged in the index. It does not include ignored files. To include an ignored file in the default stash workflow, it must first be force-added with `git add -f` so it is staged. When tracking the file is not appropriate, `git stash --all` is the explicit alternative that also includes ignored files.

Reset and history

`git reset --hard` moves the current branch pointer to a selected commit and resets the index and working tree. Commits after the selected point disappear from the branch's visible history.

Revert and history

`git revert` creates a new commit whose changes reverse an earlier commit. The original commit and the previous history remain present, so the reversal itself is recorded in history.

Distributed collaboration

After commits are pushed, collaborators can base their local work on the shared remote history. Rewriting that shared history makes their local history diverge and requires reconciliation. Adding a new reversing commit preserves the shared sequence and can be pulled normally.